

# Richard Bonnette

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## Professional Summary

IT professional with over a decade of experience spanning IT support, system administration, cloud technologies, and DevOps practices. Starting as an IT Technician and evolving into a System Administrator at Seedbox, I progressively expanded my expertise in infrastructure, automation, and cloud architecture. At Thales Canada, I played a key role in designing, deploying, and scaling Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) environments for development teams, helping modernize the company's software delivery processes and promote a cloud-native mindset. I'm a self-taught problem-solver with strong adaptability, empathy, and a passion for continuous improvement.

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## Work Experience

### DevOps Engineer

**Thales Canada**

**July 2019 - November 2025**

- Led efforts to design, deploy, and maintain secure and scalable AKS clusters for internal development teams, enabling project-specific Kubernetes environments aligned with Thales' digital transformation initiatives.
- Collaborated with developers to coach them on Kubernetes, GitOps, infrastructure as code (IaC), and cloud-native best practices.
- Initially developed infrastructure using **Terraform**, later transitioning to **Terragrunt** to increase flexibility and reduce deployment complexity.
- Achieved deployment times of ~30 minutes for new clusters (when not throttled by Azure).
- Scaled AKS fleet from ~80 to ~200 clusters by refactoring configuration responsibilities and leveraging GitOps.

- Introduced and managed **FluxCD** to migrate cluster configuration from IaC-driven to GitOps-driven workflows, simplifying long-term maintenance.
- Built a standardized base platform using cloud-native tools:

#### **Technologies & Tools:**

- Ingress-Nginx (reverse proxy)
  - External-DNS
  - Cert-Manager with Let's Encrypt
  - Linkerd for mTLS and service mesh
  - Prometheus & Grafana for metrics and dashboards
  - Helm (application deployment)
  - Terraform / Terragrunt
  - Azure (AKS, VNET, DNS, etc.)
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## **System Administrator (Windows, Linux, AWS Cloud Architect)**

### **Seedbox**

**March 2012 - July 2019**

- Maintained local infrastructure, including domain controllers, servers, and core office systems.
- Performed hardware replacements, on-call incident response, and general systems support.
- Responsible for maintaining and updating **PCI-DSS documentation** and audit schedules.
- Implemented and improved operational workflows across infrastructure and cloud systems.

### **Key Achievements:**

- Migrated from Highwinds CDN to **AWS CloudFront**, reducing operational costs.
- Designed and implemented a content ingestion and distribution workflow for the Multimedia team.

- Deployed **Cloudability** (FinOps tool) to deliver cost visibility per project and implement anomalous-cost alerting.
  - Used **Terraform**, **CodePipeline**, and **AWS Lambda** to automate deployment of multiple "free tour" websites.
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## Education

No formal degrees listed.

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## Skills

### Technical & Professional Skills

- DevOps & CI/CD
- Kubernetes (AKS), Helm, GitOps (FluxCD)
- Terraform / Terragrunt
- Azure & AWS
- Linux & Windows System Administration
- Monitoring & Observability (Prometheus, Grafana)
- Networking fundamentals, DNS, SSL/TLS, service mesh
- Automation & scripting
- Cloud architecture
- Cost optimization / FinOps
- PCI-DSS awareness
- Strong teamwork & communication
- Problem-solving
- Decision-making & risk management

- Adaptability
  - Patience, empathy & self-learning
  - Frugal mindset
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## Certifications

- AWS Cloud Solutions Architect - **Expired**
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## Projects (Personal / Hobby)

- Operates a personal **homelab** hosting multiple applications for personal, friends, and family usage.
  - Uses automation, monitoring, and 3D printing to enhance homelab workflows.
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## Hobbies & Interests

- Cooking & BBQ
- Fishing
- Kayaking
- 3D printing
- HomeLab & automation
- Gaming (Factorio, Satisfactory, Path of Exile)